

The COLLECTOR'S GUIDE

A MONTHLY PERIODICAL DEVOTED TO FIRST EDITIONS, AMERICANA, AUTOGRAPHS, OLD NEWSPAPERS AND MAGAZINES, SHEET MUSIC, PLAYBILLS, DIME NOVELS, CURRENT AUCTION PRICES, ETC. \$2 PER YEAR. SINGLE COPIES 25c. PUBLISHED BY JAMES MADISON, P. O. BOX 124, GRAND CENTRAL ANNEX, NEW YORK.
ADVERTISING RATES ON PAGE 8.

No. 17

JANUARY

1940

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COLLECTOR'S GUIDE, NO. 17, JANUARY 1940 ***

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When writing publishers kindly mention THE COLLECTOR'S GUIDE

SAN FRANCISCO THEATRE RESEARCH MONOGRAPHS (mimeographed), Lawrence Estavan, Chief editor. Vol. 9, XIX: The French Theatre in San Francisco, pages 1-107 ... The German Theatre in San Francisco, pages 108-150 plus appendices ... Vol. 10, XXI; The Italian Theatre in San Francisco, pages 151-202. Vol. XIII; Negro Minstrelsy. (These Monographs are not for sale but only furnished to libraries and educational institutions.)

THE SACRAMENTO RIVER OF GOLD. By Julian Dana. 12mo. 7th vol. in the "Rivers of America" series. Farrar & Rinehart, New York. \$2.50.

WHISKEY REBELS: The Story of a Frontier Uprising. By Leland D. Baldwin. 326 pages, with notes and bibliography. A study of the Whiskey Insurrection of 1794. University of Pittsburgh Press, Pittsburgh, Pa. \$3.

MARCY AND THE GOLD SEEKERS: The Journal of Captain R. B. Marcy, with an account of the Gold Rush over the Southern Route. By Grant Foreman. 433 pages, illustrations and bibliography. Presents evidence that a more extensive use was made of the southern route to the California gold fields than has been generally credited. University of Oklahoma Press, Norman, Okla. \$3.

TRAILING THE FORTY-NINERS THROUGH DEATH VALLEY. By Carl I. Wheat. Reprinted as a pamphlet from Sierra Club Bulletin, June, 1939. Wheat's address is care of California Historical Society, 456 McAllister St., San Francisco.

NEW YORK, PAST AND PRESENT: ITS HISTORY AND LANDMARKS, 1524-1939. Contains 100 views reproduced and described from old prints and modern photographs. By I. N. Phelps-Stokes. Published by the New York Historical Society, New York, 1939. Price to non-members, 75c plus 7c mailing fee.

THE BIOGRAPHY OF A RIVER TOWN (Memphis). Compiled by Gerald M. Capers, Jr., from its evolution as an Indian trading post. 292 pages, with illustrations, maps, charts, and an index. University of North Carolina Press, Chapel Hill, N. C. \$3.50.

BOOK TRADE BIBLIOGRAPHY IN THE UNITED STATES IN THE NINETEENTH CENTURY. By Adolph Growoll. Reissue in facsimile of original limited edition of 1898. Contains biographical sketches of Orville A. Roorbach, Henry Stevens, Joseph Sabin, Frederick Leyboldt, etc. Brick Row Book Shop, New York. \$7.50.

TWENTY-THREE BOOKS AND THE STORIES BEHIND THEM. By John T. Winterich. 15 illustrations that were not present in the original limited edition; also contains new index. J. B. Lippincott, Philadelphia, Pa. \$2.50.

PORTRAIT OF A COLONIAL CITY: PHILADELPHIA. 1682-1838. By Harold Donaldson Eberlein and Cortlandt Van Dyke Hubbard. Panoramic account of Philadelphia during this period. J. B. Lippincott & Co., Philadelphia. \$15.

STOCKBRIDGE, 1739-1939: A Chronicle. By Sarah Cabot Sedgwick and Christina Sedgwick Narquand. Illustrated. 306 pages. Bicentennial Book Committee, Stockbridge, Mass. \$2.75.

FARE TO MIDLANDS: Forgotten Towns of Central New Jersey. By Henry Charlton Beck. Illustrated. 456 pages. E. P. Dutton & Co., New York. \$5.

ANNALS OF THE NEW YORK STAGE. By C. D. Odell. 11th volume, covering period from 1879 to 1882. Columbia University Press, New York. \$8.75.

A CENSUS OF SHAKESPEARE'S PLAYS IN QUARTO, 1594-1709.

By Henrietta C. Bartlett. Revised edition. Yale University Press, New Haven, Conn. \$10.

FORGING AHEAD. By Wilfrid Partington. 8vo. A life of Thomas James Wise, collector and "manufacturer", showing how he pulled not only the wool over astute collectors' eyes, but also the silk, cotton and rayon. G. P. Putnam's Sons, New York. \$3.50.

DAVY CROCKETT: AMERICAN COMIC LEGEND. Edited by Richard M. Dorson. 8vo. Tales from the Crockett Almanacs, 1836-56 with contemporary illustrations. Rockland Editions, 350 W. 31st St., New York. \$5.

ONE HUNDRED YEARS AT VIRGINIA MILITARY INSTITUTE. By William Couper. 4 vols., approximately each 400 pages. Illustrated with maps, drawings and photographs. Vols. 1 and 2 now ready. Vols. 3 and 4, ready in March, 1940. Garrett & Massie, Richmond, Va. \$12 for 4-vol. set. Remit \$6 for the two vols. now ready.

ONCE OVER LIGHTLY. By Charles de Zemler. 8vo. A history of barbering from the earliest times to the present. Published by the author, 30 Rockefeller Plaza, New York. \$3.75.

MUSIC AND EDGAR ALLAN POE. By May Garrettson Evans. 8vo. A bibliographical study. John Hopkins Press, Baltimore, Md. \$1.75.

THE BALTIMORE AND OHIO IN THE CIVIL WAR. By Festus P. Summers. Portrays dramatic role of great railroad in a crucial period. G. P. Putnam's Sons, New York. \$3.

DRURY LANE CALENDAR, 1747-1776. Compiled from the playbills and edited with an introduction by Dougald MacMaillan. An account of the life and work of the 18th century actor and playwright. 398 pages. Oxford University Press, New York, in co-operation with the Huntington Library, San Marino, Calif. \$7.

GHOSTS OF LONDON. By H. V. Morton. Odd nooks and corners of the London of yesterday and today. Dodd, Mead & Co., New York. \$3.

PIONEER DAYS. By Charles L. Hyde. Early days in South Dakota. G. P. Putnam's Sons, New York. \$4.

BANK OF CALIFORNIA, San Francisco. A series of historical advertisements commemorating its founding in 1864, with woodcut reproductions of historical scenes. 24 pages.

SACRAMENTO GUIDE. 220 pages, with folding map, and illustrated with reproductions of early woodcuts, lithographs, and photographs. Sacramento BEE, 1939. Paper covers, 50c. Cloth, \$1.

(Continued on page 12)

(Continued from page 2)

THE STATE OF CALIFORNIA, A MEDICO-GEOGRAPHICAL ACCOUNT. By Dr. J. Praslow, who practised medicine in San Francisco from 1849 to 1856. (A translation from the German edition issued in Gottingen in 1857). Published by J. J. Newbegin, San Francisco, 1939. \$3.

MR. CIBBER OF DRURY LANE. By Richard Hindry Barker. 8vo. Colley Cibber's life. Columbia University Press, New York. \$3.

RECOLLECTIONS OF A TULE SAILOR. By John Leale. 300 pages with 19 pages of illustrations. Authentic details of San Francisco's river and ferryboat traffic, told by a veteran master and pilot of San Francisco Bay since the early 60's. George Fields, San Francisco, Calif. \$3.

THE THEATRE HANDBOOK AND DIGEST OF PLAYS. By Bernard Sobol. A reference work about the theatre and its people, including concise synopses of nearly 1000 plays, etc. Crown Publishers, New York. \$3.

(If otherwise difficult to procure, Current Books can be ordered from THE COLLECTOR'S GUIDE, at publishers' prices. Free delivery. If unobtainable, money will be promptly refunded.)

Amateur Journalists Who Became Famous

In “The Career and Reminiscences of an Amateur Journalist,” Thos. G. Harrison states that Nathaniel Hawthorne was really a pioneer member of the clan, having gotten out six weekly issues of a periodical of this description, called THE SPECTATOR, the first number appearing Aug. 21, 1820. Thus it predates by three years what many have heretofore accepted as his first literary effort, in the SALEM GAZETTE, in 1823.

Prior to its appearance, Hawthorne, at that time a youth of 16, got out a preliminary prospectus, stating that THE SPECTATOR would be issued on Wednesdays, at 12c per annum, payment to be made at the end of the year. In an early issue, Hawthorne advertised that he proposed to publish by subscription, a new edition of “The Miseries of Authors,” to which he promised to add a sequel containing facts and remarks drawn from his own experience.

Truman J. Spencer, for many years a historian on amateur journalism, questions whether a copy of either THE SPECTATOR or Hawthorne’s prospectus, is in existence today. Here, then, is an opportunity for ambitious bibliophiles and rare book speculators to ransack the garrets of their ancestors, and “see what they can see.” Harrison states that THE SPECTATOR was neatly written by the hand of Hawthorne. It was probably manifolded by some crude reproducing process of that period.

THE JUVENILE PORT-FOLIO,

AND

LITERARY MISCELLANY,

DEVOTED TO THE INSTRUCTION AND AMUSEMENT OF YOUTH.

A lasting wreath of various hue,—we'll'd with each fragrant flower.

Vol. I.]

SATURDAY, OCTOBER 17, 1812.

[No. 1.

CONDITIONS.

A No. will be published every Saturday.

The price is only Twelve and a Half Cents per month, payable in advance.

No subscription will be received for less than three months. At the close of each year, a title page and index, for the volume; also, a list of the names of the subscribers will be given.

TO THE JUVENILE PUBLIC.

THE title to address the public, when a periodical work is first offered for patronage, is established by custom, and a deviation from the general usage, would be a breach of decorum, since the public are desirous, as a right, what sincerely is granted as a courtesy, and, of late years, more labour is bestowed in writing these "Hypocritical of promises," than in ransoming up the original work. As it seems required, therefore, of every candidate, that he should publicly declare his pretensions to favour, the Editor, in compliance with the general custom, deems it necessary, briefly to state the intention of the present work; and, in this, as well as in his Editorial capacity, in general, he respectfully solicits from his patrons, that indulgence, which the inexperience of youth so amply requires. In order, therefore, to make up for his own deficiency, he respectfully solicits the favour and assistance of such of the "Literary Youth," as may have time and inclination, to favour him with their communications. He has, also, the promise of a few gentlemen of polite taste, to condescend their aid, to diffuse elegant and instructive literature, to soothe trembling ment, and to ROSE AND FOSTER IMPART GRACIOUSLY.

The columns of the JUVENILE PORT-FOLIO, will contain all the variety of subject, and Miscellaneous literature, which Magazines, and other periodical literary works, usually contain: Selected with particular attention to those subjects, that are adapted to the improvement, edification, and rational amusement of youth. In our searches after variety, a preference will always be given to those papers, which are characterized by elegance of expression, clarity of thought, and value of information. "Though we shall teach, like the Bee, upon every plant in the garden of literature, we shall only extract from those which produce sweets, and diffuse fragrance."

Besides the more general subjects of literature, its pages will always be open to such extracts of popular interest, as may be judicious and entertaining; also a general selection of more anecdotal points of wit, brilliant repartee, &c. Our purpose will be to render this department, brief without licentiousness, brilliant without triviality, and elegant without elaboration.

In the region of the Muse, we particularly solicit aid, but we fear "none from the voice of inspiration." We only venture, however, to hope, that the personal of our selected poetry will excite emulation, as no piece will be admitted, which cannot lay some claim to true genius and poetical merit.

The Editors will receive the JUVENILE PORT-FOLIO as an entertaining companion, studious of their to wit, to courtesy manners as: valuable information; and the Gentleman will find in it, a month and correct conduct, which we hope will not be unworthy of their regard; as we shall ever be anxious to please the Public, the Learned, the Witty and the Fair, with these views, we are emboldened to ask the patronage of the public.

"And, confident of praise, IF PRAISE BE DUE,
"Trust that fear, to merit and to You."

(Courtesy Franklin Memorial Institute)

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Trust without fear, to merit and to You.”

But Hawthorne was not the first to publish a “boys’ paper.” From a pamphlet on “Amateur Journalism,” issued by Will G. Snow of Meriden, Conn., to commemorate “An Association of Amateur Journalists of the Past,” called “The Fossils,” we learn that the earliest known American example is THE JUVENILE PORTFOLIO AND LITERARY MISCELLANY, an eight-page weekly, published from Oct. 17, 1812 to Dec. 7, 1816 by Thomas G. Condie, Jr., at 22 Carter’s Alley, opposite Stephen Girard’s Bank, Philadelphia, as per illustration herewith.

After the demise of Hawthorne’s periodical, amateur journalism seemingly went into a slumber twice as long as the famed sleep of Rip Van 4 Winkle. However, in 1858, came the COOS HERALD of Lancaster, N. H., and by 1872, approximately 200 amateur gazettes were being turned out. At this period the juvenile journal considered as having the largest circulation, was OUR BOYS, started in Chicago in 1871 as a “four-pager,” and which by 1873 had evolved into a 16-page periodical almost as large as HARPER’S WEEKLY. In its prime it is said to have enjoyed a circulation of 10,000 copies per issue. Most of these sheets varied in size from 4 pages of 3 by 4 inch dimensions to 32 pages, measuring 10 by 12, the latter about the width of four ordinary newspaper columns. The average life of an amateur paper was estimated at 8 months, which period was ample to disgust most youthful journalists with the hardships of an editorial career.

In 1869, it was deemed advisable to organize an association for mutual acquaintance, social intercourse and to assist the cause of amateur journalism throughout the United States. A meeting was held in New York at the residence of Charles Scribner, from which evolved the National Amateur Press Association. Nellie Williams, a 13-year miss, is credited as being the first “female of the species.” She issued the PENFIELD EXTRA soon after the commencement of the Civil War. It had been planned to issue an amateur journal at the Centennial Exposition of 1876, and it was said that \$5000 could have been raised without difficulty for that purpose, but

Director General Goshorn would not allot space, claiming that the word “amateur” savored of infancy of mind.

When approximately half a century ago, George Harrison announced himself as a candidate for the presidency of the Western Amateur Press Association, his ambition did not meet with unanimous endorsement, if we consider the following outburst from a rival sheet:

“We smelt the smell of a dead rat when we received a copy of the WELCOME VISITOR, stating that Harrison is a candidate for the position of President of the Western Amateur Press Association, against Wyn Morris. We can inform the gentleman from Indiana that he is on the hull of a sinking ship, and when he grasps for the exalted position he has in view, it will melt before his eyes, and he will gradually sink into the waters of oblivion. George, dear George, you are left sure.”—AMATEUR IOWAN.

To this not over-delicate prognostication, the Harrison clan replied in kind as set forth below:

“THE IOWAN no doubt smelt its own smell, eh. As for Harrison being left in the race, we beg to inform our IOWA contemporary, in all probability it is entirely mistaken. No other candidate now in the field has a better chance than he.”—The WELCOME VISITOR.

Let us quote one more expression of opinion, as one contempt-orary to another:

“In our estimation nothing is so contemptible as to publish an article against an individual and then refuse to send him a copy of the paper containing the attack. The low-lived editors of the YOUNG DEMOCRAT should paste this in their hats.”—THE ACORN, St. Louis.

At the time Mr. Snow wrote his “Amateur Journalism” pamphlet, in 1922, the Fossil Library, consisting of 50,000 old amateur papers, was located at 150 Nassau St., New York. It has since been moved to the Franklin Memorial Institute, Philadelphia, where it will be permanently preserved under the care of the Curtis Family of SATURDAY EVENING

POST fame. The second largest collection is owned by Truman J. Spencer, of Hamden, Conn., while Vincent B. Haggery of Jersey City, N. J., has one of the very few known files of the official organ of the National Amateur Press Association, embracing 63 years. Any one interested can obtain information as to other fine collections by writing to Edwin H. Smith, Librarian of the N.A.P.A., 524 N. Kenmore St., Philadelphia.

As to amateur journalists who subsequently reached exalted ranks as authors or publishers, Mr. Spencer has kindly furnished me with the following list:

FRANK B. NOYES, publisher Washington STAR, at age of 12 ran the TIMES.

THEODORE BODENWEIN (recently deceased), publisher of the New London DAY, at 17 ran the THAMES BUDGET.

E. H. STAIR, owner Detroit FREE PRESS, ran OUR BOYS AND GIRLS, in 1873.

JOSEPHUS DANIELS, publisher of the Raleigh NEWS AND OBSERVER, and ex-Secretary of the Navy, at age of 12 ran the CORNUCOPIA.

RICHARD W. GILDER, for many years editor of the CENTURY MAGAZINE, ran the REGISTER at 16.

CYRUS H. K. CURTIS, S. E. POST AND LADIES' HOME JOURNAL publisher, conducted YOUNG AMERICA at the age of 14.

JOHN THAYER, well-remembered as publisher of EVERYBODY'S MAGAZINE and the SMART SET, when only 13, ran the PRINTER.

GEORGE B. M. HARVEY, one of the final publishers of HARPER'S WEEKLY, issued the DEMOCRAT when only 14.

There were many other eminent publishers that lack of space compels us to omit. And as for authors who became famous, Robert Louis Stevenson

issued the SUNBEAM MAGAZINE when 16; Frank Baum who wrote "The Wizard of Oz" published the HOME JOURNAL in 1868; and Walter Pritchard, New York theatre critic, and author of numerous books on the drama, joined the amateur ranks at 12.

According to Mr. Spencer, amateur journalism still exists and continues to hold a fascination for many youths of today. From the speculative standpoint, however, there is at present no active demand for an oldtime collection thereof, although probably some individual with an ample purse and a nostalgia for youth, would be happy to possess one, and pay well for it. But who and where he is, it will take a wiser person than the editor of this publication, to identify.

Collectors of this interesting phase of Americana, will look forward with pleasurable anticipation to the publication of a book entitled "History of Amateur Journalism," on which Truman J. Spencer has been working for years. The outline of contents will comprise, DEFINITION AND DESCRIPTION ... THE PIONEERS ... EXCHANGING AND ORGANIZING ... THE NATIONAL AMATEUR PRESS ASSOCIATION ... RIVAL ORGANIZATIONS ... SECTIONAL AND LOCAL ORGANIZATIONS ... LITERATURE AND BOOKS ... THE FOSSILS ... APPENDIX. Full information as to the date of publication, price, etc., can be obtained by writing to Truman J. Spencer, 2525 Whitney Ave., Hamden, Conn.

The famous rooming house at 61 Washington Square, N. Y., conducted for more than fifty years by Mme. Katherine Branchard, and since her decease in 1937, by her daughter-in-law, is no more. During their years of struggle it was a haven of repose for Willa Cather, Frank Norris, Gelett Burgess, Theodore Dreiser and Adelina Patti. After their departure from the Branchard House, which incidentally is over 100 years old, they wrote her letters from all parts of the world, and these should produce some good autographic material.

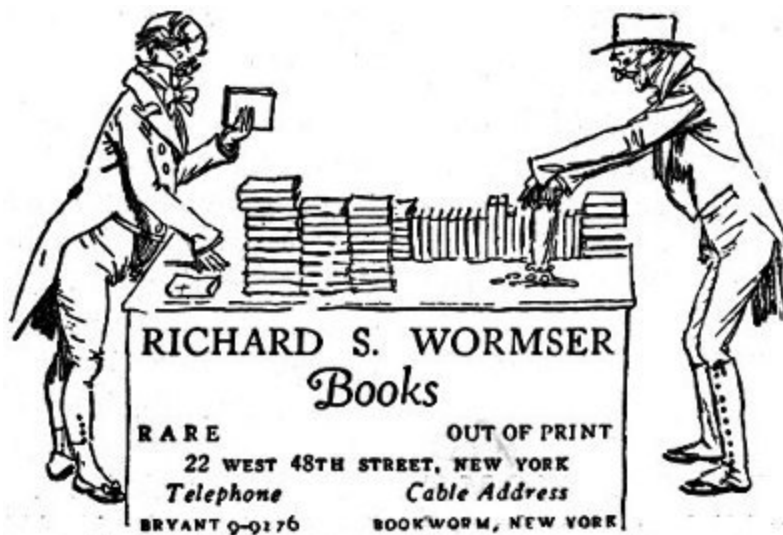
Mrs. Adelaide M. Faron, of the Walt Whitman Society of America, and Librarian of the Hempstead Library, Hempstead, Long Island, N. Y., recently held at the Adelphia College, Garden City, N. Y., an exhibition of

rare items and newly discovered manuscripts pertaining to the “good gray poet”.

Here is a little good advice from that past master of sheet music knowledge, Wm. McDevitt, 2079 Sutter St., San Francisco. In his very entertaining monthly called BOOK-COLLECTING (50 cents a year) he says:—“In buying first editions of old songs, you will be safer in most cases if the sheet music doesn’t contain ads on the back cover; you will generally do well to distrust copies with the copyright line on front apparently worn out with repeated printings.”

The large mass of propaganda from both foreign and domestic pressure groups is being collected and classified by the Carnegie Library of Washington and the Washington and Lee University of Lexington, Va.

The Smithsonian Institution, Washington, D. C., has acquired a collection of photographs of real Wild West Indians, made by John K. Hillers, 66 years ago.



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Good Investments In Autographs

Written for THE COLLECTOR'S GUIDE by Mary A. Benjamin



Allied News-Photo

Frequently I am asked, "What is a safe investment in autographic material over a long period of years?" The answer may well come from my

experience gained in this field during the past decade. The boom years of 1928 and 1929 sent many items of a literary, historical and musical character sky-rocketing, although subsequently they shot down just as suddenly, 1938 seeing prices at probably their lowest level in 25 years. And yet, just as in the case of rare books, some forms of autograph material suffered less than others. The knowledge thus gained, helps materially to light the pathway as to what is the best sort of autographic material to consider for future investment.

Today, the safest buy seems to be good Presidential letters written either before or during their terms of office, preferably the latter. These letters must have worthwhile contents. Uninteresting documents of our Chief Executives are all too common and sell at nominal figures. Signers of the Declaration of Independence and of the Constitution are also excellent, that is, if the contents measure up. In the literary domain, authors' letters about their works are always sought for, although prices are more inclined to fluctuate than on historical items.

Of late, increased interest has been evinced in the "War between the States," or, as it is called up North, the Civil War. An added lure is that prices for this sort of material, are almost at rock-bottom, as collectors are just beginning to wake up to its importance. The years will see good war letters of famous Federal and Confederate Generals go very high. The upward swing has already begun.

A new field which has sprung up recently is that of State collections. The country has heretofore been too young to care much for the historical records of individual localities. But with the development of the nation, this interest has steadily grown, and today, all letters relating to internal politics of individual states or cities are being sought, the competition having a healthy effect upon prices.

Early Mormon material, and records pertaining to Texas, Michigan, Colorado, Virginia, California, etc., are in active demand, thus enabling the average dealer to place them without difficulty almost as fast as received. Furthermore, whereas a collector may become discouraged in buying a complete set of Signers because of the super-rarity of a few names, there is little difficulty in obtaining the two or three Signers belonging to

the collector's home state, to say nothing of famous Generals, literary lights, composers, etc.

The one, almost unchanging code of the collector should be to buy hand-written letters of good date, and of unusual, historical, or otherwise excellent content. Fine items seem to hold their value pretty well, even in times of financial stress, and with the years should edge upwards in price. Less desirable items will fluctuate considerably. To sum up, good autographs provide the best expectation for at least a fair dividend on the money invested. On the other hand, common items that have little to recommend them except cheapness, are almost invariably a disappointment as far as the hope of satisfactory returns, are concerned. There are occasional exceptions but this rule holds true 98% of the time. In closing, may I also stress the importance of being sure that what you purchase is genuine. Unless you are an expert yourself, the safest way is to acquire your pen treasures only through a dealer on whose reliability and experience you can absolutely depend.

Walter Hart Blumenthal, rare book specialist at 1775 Broadway, New York, is frequently called upon to contribute articles on odd books, such as for example a Shorthand Bible, a Latin Life of Washington, "Alice in Wonderland" in Esperanto, and a book bound in human skin. Shortly THE COLOPHON will present an article by Mr. Blumenthal on books in which the text and illustrations are pierced into the vellum, letter by letter, the pages being backed by colored silk. In all the world, only seven such early volumes are known, he states.

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A Book Stamp Innovation



As Flodden W. Heron aptly observed in a recent issue of the ARGONAUT, it is estimated by the Postal Department that one person out of every fifteen is interested in stamp collecting. There are over twenty-five journals issued exclusively for stamp collectors, and three hundred and two American newspapers maintain stamp departments. In addition sixty-four radio stations conduct regular stamp broadcasts. Book collectors constitute a much smaller group, and to date there has been no connection between these two enthusiastic armies of “acquisitioners.” To bring these two groups into closer cooperation, Mr. Heron recently suggested to the Pacific Philatelic Society of San Francisco the use of postage stamps of authors as association items for collected books. Investigation disclosed that postage stamps had been issued in honor of nearly one hundred authors.

He states that the idea occurred to him when coming into possession of a Stamp Case, invented by Lewis Carroll of “Alice in Wonderland” fame. It contained twelve pockets for stamps of different denominations. Progressively this gave birth to the thought of using stamps as association items in connection with first editions, artistically affixing them to fly-

leaves, inside covers, or occasionally to title pages. Time will increase the scarcity or rarity of the stamps, and in some instances, as with certain bookplates, greatly enhance the value of the books to which they are affixed. Of course we must bear in mind that the number who collect stamps exceeds greatly those whose interest is in rare books. At the same time, many high school and college students and other groups, would like to collect books but cannot afford the prices of first editions. However, if postage stamps are classified as association items, thousands can buy books not first editions, but good reading copies. The inserting of proper stamps, will permit of book collecting on an inexpensive scale, because it is only necessary to watch dates, and acquire first-day "covers" for merely the regular price of the stamps. And as time goes on, these first issues will have increased value for book insertion, quite aside from their desirability to stamp collectors. For example, a copy of "Leaves of Grass," issued by the Modern Library, with a first-day Whitman "cover" laid in, should fetch over double the cost of the book within a year after the stamp was issued. And this, in spite of the fact that a postage stamp in connection with a book can not be compared with an author's inscription or presentation. It can be more likened to a bookplate, which has been added to the volume by some one other than the author. Two of Mr. Heron's favorite authors are Lewis Carroll and Sir Walter Scott, and as he could find of them no existing postage stamps, he had two made, for his personal use, which serve as illustrations for this article. We feel certain that Mr. Heron will be glad to answer 10 any question pertaining to book stamps on the part of those interested, if they will address their inquiries to him at Mills Building, San Francisco.

Temple Scott, rare book expert, died on Sept. 30th. in Edinburgh. Among his many activities, he had been adviser in the assembling of some of the notable private libraries of this country, including those of Jerome Kern, and the late William H. Woodin, former Secretary of the Treasury. The Kern collection was considered one of the most valuable ever gotten together in America, and in 1929 was sold at auction for \$1,300,000. Also remembered are some of Mr. Scott's outstanding purchases including the letters of Lord Chesterfield for which he paid \$75,000, and the original text which Sir Walter Scott prepared for a definitive edition of his novels, and which set him back \$150,000.

The first volume of Dr. Greg's "Bibliography of the English Drama to 1640" is reported as ready. Information regarding it can be obtained from R. B. McKerrow, Picket Place, Wendover, Bucks, England.

Mrs. Nellie Dumont, widow of the minstrel king, Frank Dumont, died several months ago at her home, 1207 Green St., Philadelphia, Penna., where she had resided for 60 years. Mr. Dumont in his lifetime, possessed an unusually fine collection of theatrical material, and to this day, as far as we know, it has never been definitely established, just what became of it.

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A list of old magazines and newspapers that are worth real money, in the February issue of THE COLLECTOR'S GUIDE.

HOW TO TELL FIRST EDITIONS

When the date of the publication is not in brackets, it means that the same will be found on title page. When, however, it is in brackets, thus, (1931), it indicates that said date is printed either on the reverse side of title page, or in some other part of the book. Or, possibly, the date does not appear at all, in which case the brackets are merely authoritative information supplied by the bibliographer. Furthermore, our endeavor has been to list only authors and books for which there is a reasonably active present-day demand, and which have a speculative future.

LOUISA MAY ALCOTT (1832-1888)

LITTLE WOMEN. 2 vols. First volume has no announcement for "Little Women, Part Two" at foot of last page of text, nor has it "Part One" on the backstrip; Second volume has the notice regarding "Little Women: Part One" at page IV. Usually bound in green or red cloth, but other colors show up occasionally. Boston, 1868-1869.

THOMAS BAILEY ALDRICH (1836-1907)

THE STORY OF BAD BOY. Generally regarded as the story of his own boyhood. Has "scattered" for "scatter" on page 14, line 20, and "abroad" for "Aboard" on page 197, line 10. Green cloth binding. Boston, 1870.

HERVEY ALLEN (1889-)

ANTHONY ADVERSE, New York, 1933. 105 copies de luxe edition, 3 vols. signed. Trade edition is in one volume, with publisher's monogram on copyright page. On page 352, line 6, Xaxier for Xavier. On page 397, line 22, the word found is repeated. On page 1086, line 18, ship for shop.

SHERWOOD ANDERSON (1876-)

WINESBURG, OHIO. New York, 1919. First printing said to have both unstained and orange stained tops.

T. S. ARTHUR (1809-1885)

TEN NIGHTS IN A BAR ROOM. Philadelphia, 1854. This holds priority over an edition the same year published in Boston.

IRVING BACHELLER (1859-)

EBEN HOLDEN. There is a pine-cone design on backstrip with rounded top. In later editions, a flat top was substituted. Boston (1900).

RAY STANNARD BAKER (1870-)

ADVENTURES IN CONTENTMENT. By David Grayson (pseudonym). New York, 1907. Green pictorial cloth, about 1-3/16 inches thick. Illustration on page 110, shows cows grazing. Second state is bound in dark green, olive cloth, without illustration on page 110, of man plowing.

JOHN KENDRICK BANGS
(1862-1922)

A HOUSE-BOAT ON THE STYX. New York, 1896.

EDWARD BELLAMY
(1850-1898)

LOOKING BACKWARD, 2000-1887. Comes in gray, green, yellowish and perhaps other colors of cloth; also in paper wrappers. Cloth-bound copies hold priority. They are said to have been issued in the Spring, whereas those in wrappers didn't appear until Fall. The first state has printer's imprint on copyright page. Boston, 1888.

AMBROSE BIERCE (1842-1914?)

THE FIEND'S DELIGHT. By Dod Grile (pseudonym). London (1872). Vignette on title page. Red-brown pictorial cloth. American edition, 1873, had no publisher's advertisements at back.

NUGGETS AND DUST. By Dod Grile (pseudonym). London (1872) First edition of author's first book. Original yellow pictorial wrappers. Should have half-title, with two pages of advertisements preceding the half-title, and ten pages of advertisements at the end.

THE DANCE OF DEATH. By William Herman (pseudonym). San Francisco (1877) First state has on its title page, in addition to title and author, the words "Author's copy". Has no press notices at back of book. Second state has imprint of Henry Keller & Co., 543 Clay St., 1877. THE DANCE OF LIFE by Mrs. Dr. J. Milton Bowers, and purporting to be an answer, is sometimes considered as a companion piece.

TALES OF SOLDIERS AND CIVILIANS. Issued in green cloth and probably also other colors. White end-papers. E. L. G. Steele, San Francisco, 1891.

BLACK BEETLES IN AMBER. Has imprint of Western Authors Publishing Co. Cloth and wrappers. San Francisco and New York, 1892.

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Stick 'Em Up

As a preface to "Books on Western Gunmen," by Guy J. Giffen, in the Quarterly NEWS-LETTER of the Book Club of California, an editorial note states that not the least interesting subdivision of Americana is that relating to the bandits and gunmen of the Old West. The extensive literature on the subject offers a tempting field to collectors with a taste for the history and legend surrounding this phase of the Winning of the West. Mr. Giffen's extensive library of books on Western outlaws is the result of a hobby of years' standing.

Mr. Giffen's article maintains that any well-rounded collection of Western Americana should have a division of books on gunmen, and mentions a number of men and titles that will serve as a general guide to their selection. Of particular interest are the books on Murrieta. "Joaquin Murrieta, the Brigand Chief of California" was published by the CALIFORNIA POLICE GAZETTE in 1854, and is now very rare, only two copies being known, both in private collections. According to Franklin Walker as set forth in "San Francisco's Literary Frontier," John Rollin Ridge, partly of Indian blood, who came to San Francisco in 1850, furnished the GAZETTE with much of its source material when he wrote "The Life and Adventures of Joaquin Murrieta, the Celebrated California Bandit." In 1859, the GAZETTE reprinted the story with additions but also in this instance, only two copies are known to have survived. Of the many later treatments of Murrieta, one of the best is "The Life and Adventures of the Celebrated Bandit Joaquin Murrieta," translated from the Spanish of Ireneo Paz, by Frances P. Belle. (Chicago, 1925).

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This is a readable account of his exploits, but it credits him with superhuman ability, and relates incidents that could not have happened. In Mr. Giffen's belief, Murrieta's true history has not yet been told and at this late date, it is unlikely that it ever will be. It may be interesting to collectors of Murrietana, to note that in 1880, a play was produced at the Adelphi Variety Theatre, San Francisco, purporting to picture the life of 14 Murrieta. It was called "The Scarlet IX."

Stories of two California bandits of a much later date, Evans and Sontag, are related in "The 25th Man", published in 1924. The author, Ed Morrell, gives a readable account of his experiences with these outlaws, bearing however a bit heavily on the first person. The exploits of Evans and Sontag were also offered to the public in dramatic form, at the National Theatre, San Francisco, in the early nineties, some of the bandit's children having been engaged as a sort of "added attraction."

C. B. Glasscock's "Bandits and the Southern Pacific" (New York, 1929) is also an interesting narrative. "Old Waybills", by Alvin F. Harlow (New York, 1934) while primarily concerned with the pioneer express companies,

gives entertaining accounts of Black Bart, Jesse and Frank James, Sam Bass and the Daltons, and indicates a sincere effort to gather the facts. The books of Owen P. White have added much to present-day popular knowledge of the outstanding killers and peace officers of the Old West. His "Them Was the Days" (New York, 1925), "Trigger Fingers" (New York, 1926), and "Lead and Likker" (New York, 1932) make exciting reading and present a true picture so far as the truth can now be known. "Triggernometry" by Eugene Cunningham (New York, 1935) is another sincere endeavor to treat the gunmen as human beings rather than supermen.

Returning to books about individual bandits, one of the best is "Wild Bill Hickok—Prince of Pistoleers", by Frank J. Wilstach (New York, 1928), this work also containing many illustrations of more than passing interest. "Wild Bill" (James Butler) Hickok has been much written about. Probably the best account of his connection with the famous McCanlas affair was published in the NEBRASKA HISTORY MAGAZINE for April-June, 1927. In it, the story of Colonel Nichols, published previously in HARPER'S MAGAZINE of February, 1867 (and copied practically by every biographer of Hickok) is disproved.

Of nineteen volumes dealing with the James gang, "The Rise and Fall of Jesse James," by Robertus Love (New York, 1925) seems the most thorough and unbiased biography. An important and scarce James item is "The Trial of Frank James for Murder," by George Miller, Jr., privately printed in Missouri in 1898. It gives in detail information not to be found elsewhere. The list could go on indefinitely, for the period of the gunmen extended from the Civil War to the middle 90's, and the literature on the subject is limitless. Much of it, of course, is lurid, sensational material, written solely for entertainment and with no claim to historical accuracy. But there are also many more pretentious works: good, bad and indifferent. Many otherwise excellent biographies of Western gunmen are marred by the fact that the author's treatment is colored by his admiration or contempt for his subject. But, perhaps, that is a failing of biographers in general.

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INCUNABULA

In a recent article in the New York TIMES, Philip Brooks, noted rare book commentator, remarked that there is nothing particularly mysterious about incunabula. A polysyllabic Latin word with an impressive sound, it means simply cradle books, or books published during the infancy of printing. They occupy only a short span in the history of books, no more than about fifty years, from the middle to the end of the fifteenth century. To many collectors they are the true aristocrats, not only for their antiquity, but often for their artistic beauty. For nearly 500 years printers have been trying but none have been able to approach the typographical perfection of the Gutenberg Bible, which was finished around 1455. Even the paper of these ancients is of superior quality that they will outlive most books issued today.

Mr. Brooks further declared that while a common objection to collecting incunabula is that they are incomprehensible, being printed in dead languages that nobody reads nowadays, it is nevertheless a fact that before the end of the century, books were being published freely in the vernacular, and Caxton and his successors were making valuable contributions to English literature in their native tongue.

Since the middle of the seventeenth century, when the output of the fifteenth century first began to attract notice as collectible objects, they have been subject to such intensive scrutiny that they are now the most thoroughly bibliographed books in the world. From Panzer (1793-1803) and Hain (1826-1834), who described 16,300 titles, the scientific study evolved through the brilliant work of Bradshaw and Proctor until its culmination in the British Museum catalogue.

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Moreover, collectors today who look somewhat wistfully on the mounting prices of fifteenth century editiones principes (which means first editions) of Gutenberg Bibles even in single leaves, or of that familiar favorite, the Nuremberg Chronicle, are probably unaware that many incunabula are still available for much less than \$100. The elusiveness and high price of all incunabula are as much a fiction as the belief that it is impossible to identify individual volumes. 16

It is generally admitted that there are in existence some 40,000 separate editions of books published during the fifteenth century. No one has yet had the hardihood to attempt to count all the known copies of these editions. One of the best modern efforts to gauge their extent was that of K. W. Hiersemann in his "Verlagskatalog", Leipzig, 1924. He estimated that there were at least 450,000 pieces of incunabula around, or an average of more than eleven copies of each known edition.

In undertaking to investigate the present-day holdings of incunabula in all countries, Fremont Rider, librarian of the Olin Library at Wesleyan University, reported that Germany, the birthplace of printing and native home of most incunabula, is still, according to the latest available records, the largest holder of such books. With 105 libraries owning a hundred volumes or more, it registers a total of 115,927 volumes. Italy ranks second with 70,721. France makes a poor third with 35,278, just nosing out Great Britain's 34,045. Austria comes next, outranking the United States, which can muster 22,166 volumes. Poland, Switzerland, Czecho-Slovakia, Spain, Holland and Russia follow next in order. In the 25 countries listed with libraries of a hundred or more volumes, Mr. Rider has located 380,750 titles.

The outstanding single collection of incunabula is in the Bayerische Staatsbibliothek at Munich, with its 16,000 volumes. The British Museum comes second with 11,500, the Bibliotheque Nationale third with 10,000. The Huntington Library's 5,200 take sixth place, while the 3,600 in the Library of Congress entitle it to rank seventeenth among the libraries of the world. Despite the great influx of incunabula into this country in recent years, the resources of the European collections are incomparable. It is perfectly true that most American libraries regard the acquisition of a single incunabulum as a rare treasure, while many unheard-of European libraries of religious orders or princely families own far more volumes than our largest and richest universities.

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Mr. Rider's analysis makes no attempt to assay the contents of the various collections, as his concern is only with a quantitative analysis. Some of the scarcest and most important incunables have found their way into this country. As a result of an inquiry among the 236 most likely sources in the United States, a table is shown giving the relative sizes of incunabula collections in twelve institutions and over a hundred colleges and universities. Following the Huntington and the Library of Congress are Harvard University with 1,860 volumes, the Pierpont Morgan Library with 1,800 and the Newberry Library with 1,634. The Folger Shakespeare Library contains a surprisingly large Shakespearean ancestry of 250 fifteenth century sources. The summary leaves out of account the growing

private collections, confined mostly to this country, whose numbers should materially affect the figures and perhaps the order of rank. Otherwise it gives a satisfactory account of the distribution of incunabula in public institutions.

Collecting Medical Literature

An Interview With An Authority

Hello, Henry Schuman.

Hello, James Madison.

Since moving from Detroit to 730 Fifth Avenue, New York, are you continuing to make a specialty of medical rarities?

Yes indeed, in fact more so than ever.

What class of collectors go in for medical books?

Mostly members of the medical profession, but also general collectors along scientific lines of which medicine is an integral part.

Do collectors of medical literature aim to cover the entire field?

Not in most instances. They usually specialize in branches that encompass their special interests, such for example as physiognomy, transfusion of blood, heart disorders, venereal ailments, etc.

Has a well-selected medical library that was already assembled at say the turn of the century, increased or diminished in value?

Increased I should say, or, from a very conservative estimate, at least held its own. This is due, no doubt, to the permanent interest such a medical library holds. On the other hand, authors of literary classics, especially from the beginning of the 19th century on, are subject to increasing or waning interest due to a change of popular favor and appreciation. In the case of modern authors such as Hemingway, Faulkner, etc., this is even more noticeable. The “white-headed” literary lion of today may be on tomorrow’s bargain shelf, and vice versa.

Is the number of collectors of medical literature increasing?

Somewhat, I should say. In the late twenties, Dr. Henry E. Sigerist became head of the Institute of Medicine at John Hopkins University where his outstanding accomplishments, combined also with his splendid achievement in promoting the Bulletin of the History of Medicine, did much to stimulate new interest, especially among the younger men.

Which is the best medical bibliography?

18

Probably the best, and certainly the most concise is Garrison's "History of Medicine", first published in 1914 by W. B. Saunders Co., Philadelphia. The fourth edition was issued in 1929 and is revised and comparatively up to date. It sells for \$14.

How can one get posted on the prices of medical literature?

The Sanders Price List of Medica Incunabula gives some prices of early medicine. The cost is \$10. As far as more modern medical books and miscellany are concerned, I believe the best guide is dealers' lists who specialize in this sort of thing. I myself get out occasional catalogues of medical rarities, my latest one being issued to honor the seventieth birthday of Dr. Harvey Cushing, who is since deceased.

How do you procure the medical material that you resell?

There is no royal path that a dealer can pursue. One source is medical libraries privately owned, and which on the decease of the owner, have come into the possession of heirs who have no special interest therein, and who therefore are not adverse to turning them into ready cash. Europe, which may be termed the cradle of old medicine, holds most of the rarities, especially those of ancient vintage, and my correspondents on the other side are constantly on the watch for me.

How highly are medical periodicals regarded by collectors?

They play, as a rule, 'second fiddle' to books and pamphlets. They are quite bulky, and in harmony with the modern scheme of architectural contraction,

collectors are not inclined to grant them shelf room. The best modern outlet for medical periodicals appears to be colleges and universities, although in many instances, the seller pro tem is apt to be met with the rubber-stamp response of "Insufficient funds."

Have many facsimile reproductions been made of rare medical books and pamphlets?

Only a negligible number thus far and which have sold rather indifferently. However, with the increasing interest displayed in the collecting of medical literature, facsimiles will come more and more into their own.

Are many medical works sold at book auctions?

Hardly any, I should say. Medical books at best interest but a modest pro rata of collectors. Therefore, except in occasional instances, it has not been found profitable to include them in auction catalogues.

Who are the modern American trail blazers as far as stimulating interest in the collecting of medical literature is concerned?

In my opinion, Drs. Oliver Wendell Holmes, William Osler, and Harvey Cushing.

A New Aid to Collectors

Early in the year, the Pinwheel Press, of 142 So. 11th St., Philadelphia, will publish "Early American Sheet Music" by Harry Dichter. This is probably the first attempt to aid collectors and dealers in this fascinating field of Americana. It will be illustrated with many full-page reproductions of esteemed sheet music covers and also give much useful bibliographical information. A business announcement in this issue, gives full information as to its cost in the several editions.

About The New York Mirror

In 1823, George P. Morris in conjunction with Samuel Woodworth established the New York MIRROR. In those days Woodworth was considered quite a poet, his most permanent obeisance to the muse being "The Bucket", later more fittingly known as "The Old Oaken Bucket". The MIRROR lasted until 1842, but returned from its journalistic grave the year following and was known as the NEW MIRROR. It ran for a year and a half and stated in its last issue in Sept., 1844, that it was being discontinued because the Post Office charged it magazine postage which was much higher than that required of newspapers. Perhaps, to avail itself of this discrimination, it became a daily about this time, a weekly edition being gotten out for the benefit of the former NEW MIRROR subscribers. From Sept., 1844 to February, 1845, Edgar Allan Poe, so the "Papers of the Bibliographical Society of America" reports, was employed as critical writer. Perhaps this explains why "The Raven" was printed in the EVENING MIRROR, on Jan. 29, 1845, "by permission", from the advance sheets of the AMERICAN REVIEW where it appeared a few weeks later. While the MIRROR copy is usually spoken of as the second appearance of "The Raven", most collectors prefer it to its AMERICAN REVIEW appearance and it commands a higher price, although in neither case as much as one might conjecture.

After Willis and Morris withdrew in 1845, Hiram Fuller took charge and with certain minor changes of title, the periodical continued until 1857. Soon after Fuller came into control, he was sued by Poe for having published the Thomas Dunn English article reflecting on his character. Poe was awarded \$225 damages.

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Another instalment of “How To Tell First Editions” in the February issue of THE COLLECTOR’S GUIDE.

Stephen Foster Sheet Music Wants

Fletcher Hodges, Jr., Curator of the Foster Hall Collection in the University of Pittsburgh, Penna., advises us that the following titles are still required, and for the first satisfactory first edition copy of each received, the respective prices noted will be paid.

Beautiful Child of Song	\$100.
Happy Little Ones Are We	25.
I Will Be True To Thee	100.
Little Belle Blair	100.
Lizzie Dies Tonight	100.
Mine Is The Mourning Heart	100.
Mother, Thou'rt Faithful To Me	100.
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Some facts about Baedeker's Travel Books in the February issue of
THE COLLECTOR'S GUIDE.

Suckers' Progress

A book jobber recently found on his hands an entire warehouse full of obsolete histories in sets of 20 volumes each. They simply wouldn't sell; nobody wanted to give them away as premiums; their stock was so inferior that secondhand paper dealers laughed at the idea of purchasing them. Then inspiration came to the jobber. He expressed the entire edition to a publisher's sucker list, accompanied by the following letter.

SIR:

21

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Each sucker actually received the leather-bound edition—in fact, no cloth one existed. But every recipient, imagining that he had received the wrong books by mistake and was gypping the jobber, sent on his \$19.25 and kept the books. In no time the entire edition was sold out. (Lucius Beebe in New York HERALD TRIBUNE and reprinted by READER'S DIGEST).

The New York TIMES reports that a new Medical Library building is being erected at the Yale University of Medicine to receive Dr. Cushing's library and collections, including his letters, diaries and manuscripts. Any of his friends who wish, now or later, to present correspondence, photographs or other memorabilia for permanent preservation among the Cushing papers will receive the appreciative thanks of the university.

The late Merle Johnson, in his “American First Editions” called attention to the fact that there is no formal Bibliography of the writings of Bret Harte. The collector is referred to the sales catalogue of the Charles Meeker Kozlay sale, held at the galleries of the American Art Association some years ago and now on file at the New York Public Library. It is the only known listing of the variants and minutiae.

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The first issue of the Princeton University Library CHRONICLE contains a checklist of Winslow Homer, famed painter and designer for wood engravers, whose life span was from 1836 to 1910.

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Robert L. Shurter presents in the July, 1939, issue of the SOUTH ATLANTIC QUARTERLY, an article on "The Writing of Looking Backward", in which the facts regarding the composition, purpose, and subsequent influences of Edward Bellamy's novel are set forth.

We understand that a committee of bibliographers headed by Lawrence C. Wroth, librarian of the John Carter Brown Library, Providence, is making plans for the compilation and publication of a "Cooperative Catalogue of Americana, 1700-1800", and will be based upon material now housed in the principal libraries of this country. It will contain all eighteenth century historical material relating to the Western hemisphere, except newspapers, broadsides, maps, prints, almanacs, legislative and administrative proceedings and statute laws. A preliminary survey has disclosed that only about half of the existing material is recorded in either Sabin or Evans.

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As a Christmas greeting, Charles Heartman sent out from his Book Farm, down in Hattiesburg, Miss., a splendidly-printed pamphlet, entitled "Bibliography of the Writings and Speeches of Gabriel Wells, L.H.D." As less than 200 copies were issued, it will no doubt become a much sought-after item.

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Just What Was Needed

The United States Card Collectors' Catalog will come as a boon to gatherers of various sorts of cards, including tobacco, cigarette, candy, gum, etc. Attention is also given to associated items of silk, leather, and celluloid buttons, to say nothing of special sections devoted to playing cards, post cards, name cards and other non-insert types, tobacco albums, etc. "A pip," "An admirable piece of research," "A remarkable feat" are a few expressions of opinion from those who possess a copy. Over three years of preparation were required to compile this 90-page volume. It sells for 50c, and is published by J. R. Burdick, 417 South Crouse Ave., Syracuse, N. Y.

Hearn (Lafcadio). First Editions and Values. A Checklist for Collectors. By Wm. Targ. 12mo, boards, Chicago, 1935. Deluxe edition, limited to 50 copies, printed on Japanese vellum and signed by the compiler. \$2.50.

Targ's American First Editions and Their Prices. 12mo, cloth. Chicago, 1930. Limited to 500 copies. \$3.00.

FRANK L. DOUGHERTY

5322 N. Ludlam Ave.

Chicago, Illinois

Prophets and Profits

Some volumes, for which the demand was indeed slender several generations ago, are today the real prizes of literature. Take for example the earlier pamphlets and books of Poe, which today are virtually beyond the means of the average collector. But this circumstance need not stifle collecting enthusiasm. There are other volumes, which, while no longer cheap in terms of dollars and cents, should nevertheless double or treble in value, or perhaps even better than that, as time goes on. Of course it would be foolish to promise this as a certainty, and we shall therefore content ourselves with pointing out some “first edition nuggets” that seem to have an excellent chance of “coming into the money” at some future period. But before doing so, let us whisper in your ear, the desirability—we might almost say the necessity—of only acquiring “firsts” in fine condition. Yes, we know they’re hard to get, and also that they cost more, but in our opinion, they’re well worth the difference. Auction records have demonstrated this time and time again. And now, let us “amble beyond our preamble,” and point out a few, present-day good buys.

Were we going into this branch of literary speculation, we should endeavor to acquire the first edition, first issue of Walt Whitman’s “Leaves of Grass,” and which was published in Brooklyn, N. Y., in 1855. No need to specify here all the necessary “points,” because, unless you are a 100% bibliophile, you will probably do better acquiring this treasure through some trustworthy and sophisticated rare book dealer. In his worthy volume, “The Romance of Great Books and Their Authors,” John T. Winterich quotes an assertion made by A. Edward Newton to the effect that the first edition of the “Leaves of Grass” will reach a higher figure than any other important book published in the nineteenth century. When this declaration was made in 1924, asserts Mr. Winterich, “Leaves of Grass” was selling in the market for \$200 or less. Three years later a copy was auctioned for \$800, and in the interval since, the price has risen, at auction and rare booksellers’ catalogues, to as high as \$3,000, with no indication that a summit of value has been reached. The Chaucer Head Bookshop, of New York, recently offered a fine copy without foxing for \$1,000.

Another book with a definite speculative future is the first issue of the first edition of Mark Twain's first book, "The Celebrated Jumping Frog of Calaveras County, and Other Sketches", with the original blue cloth binding, and all the "points". It was published in New York in 1867, and at the Effrem Zimbalist sale, held at the Parke-Bernet Galleries on Nov. 15, an immaculate copy brought \$610. Beadle, the daddy of lurid American literature on a large scale, had previously published in No. 3 of his "Dime Book of Fun" an abridged version of the "Frog". And if you should happen to run across a copy in good condition, there should be no difficulty in collecting at least \$200 therefore. 31

Or if pocket-book limitations do not justify "eating quite so high on the hog", we commend the issues of HARPER'S MAGAZINE from January to August, 1894 inclusive. These contain the first printing of George Du Maurier's "Trilby". It was later published in book form, but a picture and a paragraph, which J. McNeil Whistler claimed lampooned him, were omitted from the latter, although they had appeared in the magazine, which explains why it is more sought after by collectors than the book.

Bound volumes of the Du Maurier HARPER'S without the covers are not particularly scarce and hardly to be considered from the standpoint of a speculative future. Therefore, endeavor to secure the unbound monthly parts in good condition, and with the original wrappers. At the William Harris Arnold sale in 1924, they brought \$70.

(To be continued.)

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An Honest Heritage

Thomas J. Condie, Jr., credited by Will Snow with being the earliest known publisher of an American amateur periodical, came naturally by his talents. According to Mott's "History of American Magazines," his father Thomas Condie conducted at the tail end of the 18th century, the PHILADELPHIA MONTHLY, which in 1798 had almost reached the thousand mark in circulation. Incidentally on page 101 of Goodspeed's very interesting house-organ, THE MONTH, (December) appears an aquatint of Girard's Bank which is held at \$35. The first article in this issue speaks of Condie, Jr. having gotten out his JUVENILE PORTFOLIO AND LITERARY MISCELLANY at 22 Carter's Alley, directly opposite and the aquatint apparently shows the very building.

How To Tell A Reprint

It had been our original intention to devote a page in each issue on how to detect reprints of popular historic newspapers. But so many items of more general interest are clamoring for admittance to our columns, that we are referring all inquiries to the Library of Congress, which has gotten out 17 Information Circulars on the subject.

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